

LESSON THIRTEEN

TOPIC: ENVY

TEXT: GENESIS 4:3-9, GENESIS 37:3-9

MEMORY VERSE: JAMES 3:16

For where there is envy and strife, confusion and every evil work are present.

CENTRAL TRUTH: It is essential to recognize that God calls His people to holiness, and a pure heart is necessary to receive the best from Him.

INTRODUCTION

Envy is the sorrow one feels at the prosperity of others, and it is a significant sin. As stated in Proverbs 27:4, "wrath and anger are difficult to manage, but they pale in comparison to envy." The envious individual is never satisfied; their heart is filled with the poison of corruption. We must view envy as a trait to resist and conquer.

LESSON OUTLINE

A. Consequences of Envy

1. Murder: 1 John 3:12, Genesis 4:3-9

Envy led Cain to murder Abel, despite being granted the opportunity to offer the first and best to God. There exists a form of murder that occurs within the heart. How often have you committed murder in your heart?

2. It Destroys Trust: Genesis 37:11

Envy can sever bonds, even among family members. It plants evil seeds and hardens hearts. Joseph was betrayed by his brothers due to envy.

3. Strife: Genesis 26:12-15

The Philistines attacked and obstructed Isaac's well. Although the well was a blessing for their land, they were blinded by envy.

4. Rebellion: Numbers 16:1-3

Envy gives rise to rebellion within organizations or families, as it is through rebellion that it advances its agenda.

B. STRATEGIES TO OVERCOME ENVY

1. Embrace Christ: Romans 13:13-14, Galatians 5:16

2. Allow love to prevail: 1 Corinthians 13:4

3. Cultivate contentment: Hebrews 13:5, Matthew 6:25-26, 1 Timothy 6:6-7

QUESTION: How should I respond when someone deliberately tries to incite envy in me?

CONCLUSION: Love celebrates with those who are joyful. While envy may appear to smile on the surface, it seethes within. 1 Peter 2:1 urges believers to eliminate envy from their lives. Uproot the seeds of envy and avoid creating an environment that fosters it.